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Graduate Recruitment Team

Cornwall Insight

Norwich

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Graduate Analyst Programme (September 2027) in Norwich. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Cornwall Insight's price cap forecasts, including its July 2026 forecast of around £1,700 a year for the October to December cap, are the clearest example I know of energy-market analysis that the whole country reads.

The work I am proudest of follows a consulting arc: diagnose with data, recommend a change, then make it happen. At KONG, I analysed sales patterns and used them to refine our upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%. As Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover restaurant and cocktail lounge in Glasgow, I created the house cocktails and set the specifications for its classics from launch, wrote the batch specifications the team works to, and trained around 15 bar staff, several new to cocktail bartending, to deliver them consistently.

Consulting appeals to me for the range of problems and the standard of thinking it demands: a recommendation has to be structured, evidenced and clear enough for a client to act on. My dissertation applies the same discipline to a broad question, whether governments that hedge oil for their economies change how their currencies react to OPEC news, by breaking it into three testable predictions for Norway, Russia and Mexico and testing each with event studies and difference-in-differences. In co-founding the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I built an organisation from launch to 126 members and led weekly sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC.

Cornwall Insight stands out to me because its graduates rotate across Market Intelligence, Consultancy and either the Content or Ireland teams over sixteen months, covering British, Irish and Australian energy markets. Wholesale gas prices drive much of the price cap, and my dissertation, on how OPEC supply news moves energy markets and the currencies of exporters, has given me a feel for how supply shocks travel; I would value learning how Cornwall Insight turns forces like these into forecasts that consumers, suppliers and policymakers rely on.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan